

the size of the resized partition and not the free space. So, make sure that you have resized correctly. Confirm the operation and reboot the system after it is completed. Run scandisk on the resized partition.

STEP 2 To remove an existing Windows partition and install Linux in it, make sure that no data is present in the partition. Copy its contents to another partition.

Installation

You have to start the installation by booting from the CD-ROM drive. To do so, make sure that the first boot option is set as CD-ROM. You can check this in the BIOS setup. Insert the first CD and restart the computer. You will be presented with a text-based menu. From here, follow these steps.

STEP 1 Press enter to start the graphical installation mode. Next, you will be prompted to test the media. The installation program will test your media for any flaws in it. Although you can skip this step, it is recommended that you check all the CDs at least once.

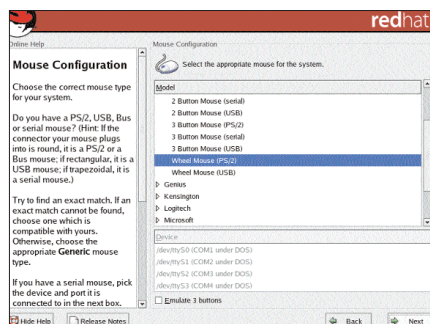


A Welcome Screen appears after selecting the graphical installation mode

STEP 2 Now, you will be presented with the Welcome Screen. Click next to enter the language selection step. No regional languages are supported; the default would be the language that you are reading. However, you can install other languages, if needed.

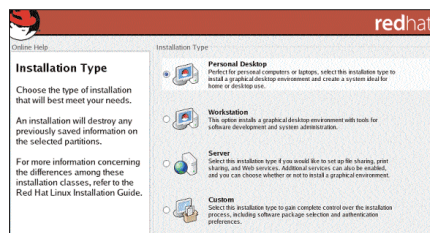
STEP 3 Keyboard configuration: Select 'U.S English' keyboard.

STEP 4 Mouse configuration: The installation program will probe your mouse and give a default option. If you are sure of the model of your mouse and find that it is wrongly listed then change it. If your mouse is connected to the serial port then make sure that the correct COM port is selected under device menu.

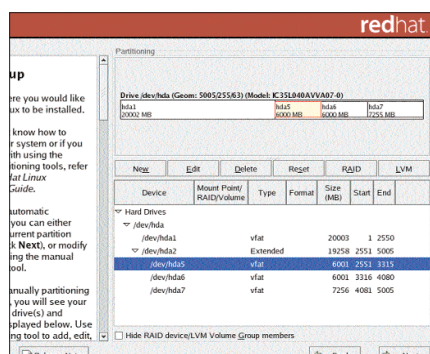


Change the default option for the mouse model, if it's wrongly listed

STEP 5 Installation type: Here, you can choose any one of the four options—personal desktop, workstation, server and custom installation. Select Personal desktop. You can always change it later, after the installation.



Choose the type of installation in the screen shown above



Manually partition the hard drives using Disk Druid

Partitioning

This is the mother of all steps. If you complete this step successfully, the rest is a breeze.

STEP 1 You can choose between 'Automatically partition', and 'Manually partition with Disk Druid'. The latter is recommended as it gives you control over the partitioning.

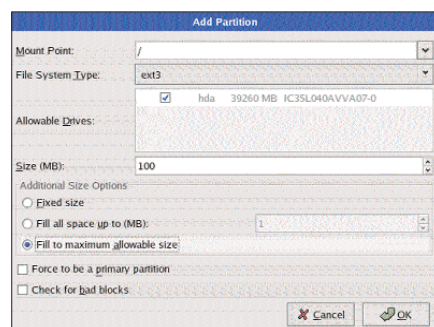
STEP 2 In the manual partition method, you will be presented a screen similar to the one shown. The actual screen will depend on your hard disk. If you have resized your partition, skip to the next step.

Before you install Linux...

- ✓ Know your system configuration. Right-click My Computer and select Properties to get information about your system.
- ✓ Check whether all your hardware components (especially the video card), are listed at <http://hardware.redhat.com/hcl/>.
- ✓ Find out its horizontal and vertical scan frequency. You can find it in the manual that accompanied the monitor.
- ✓ Make a note of the port your mouse is connected to—serial, PS2 or USB. If it is a serial port, find out whether it is COM1 or COM2.
- ✓ Windows XP users may need the setup CD if they are going to revert back after the installation.
- ✓ If your system is networked, then you should know the details of the same. Contact your system administrator for the details.
- ✓ Backup all your important data
- ✓ Defragment the hard disk

Otherwise, select the partition on which you want to install and click delete. If you are finding it difficult to relate the entries in the Disk Druid menu to the corresponding Windows partition, then refer to the box *Disk Druid—take it easy*.

STEP 3 Select the free partition, and click New. Now the add partition window will appear. In the mount point field, select '/'. Select the file system type as ext3. In the size field, select 'Fill to maximum allowable size'. If you get a warning,



Click on the New button in the Disk Druid menu, to create a new partition

click continue. If you happen to make a mistake in this step, click the Reset button and start partitioning again.

Now the easier part of installation

After partitioning, the boot loader configuration and other configurations have to be done. Here's how you do it.